

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

Round 2



Problem 5. Arapaho nouns (20 marks)

Arapaho is an Algonquian language spoken by about 1,000 people in Wyoming and Oklahoma in the United States.

Here are some Arapaho nouns in the language's official written form, plus the English meaning. Each noun has several grammatical forms.

For further explanations (including the meanings marked with *) and the questions, see the next page.



singular	plural	obviative singular	locative singular	
hisei	hiseino?	hisein	hiseinewe?	woman
hotii	hotiiwo?	hotiiw	hotiiwowe?	car
nebi	nebiho?	hibio	nebihewe?	my* older sister
neicet	neicetino		neicetine?	my* hand
nooku	nookuho?	nookuo	nookuhowe?	beaver
hisee3	hiseeto?	hiseet	(a)	pine tree
(b)	ooto		oote?	leg
beici3	beicito		beicite?	tooth
coox	(c)	(d)	(e)	enemy
ce?einox	ce?eino3o		ce?eino3e?	bag
hinen	hinenino?	(f)	(g)	man
wotoo	(h)	(i)	wotoohe?	pair of pants
(j)	wo3onohoeno	(k)	wo3onohoene?	book
(l)	(m)	nii?eihiiio	(n)	eagle
ce?ibes	ce?ibexo	(o)	(p)	block (of wood)
benes	(q)	(r)	(s)	arm
(t)	nesiho?	(u)	(v)	my* uncle

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

Round 2



Notes:

- The greyed-out cells indicate that the form does not exist.
- ʔ and 3 are both consonants. ʔ is a glottal stop, the sound in the middle of “uh-oh,” and 3 is θ, the *th* in *think*.
- Arapaho pronunciation also involves tones, which have not been included in this problem.
- The ‘obviative’, sometimes called the ‘fourth person’, is a noun form used in some languages to express how relevant an entity is. If some third-person entities (i.e., ones that are neither the speaker nor the listener) are less important than others to the conversation, they will be given the obviative marking, while the more important ones will take the standard third-person marking.
- *: One example of how obviation works involves the words whose meaning is shown as ‘my*’. In the basic uses, the possessor is indeed the speaker (i.e. ‘my’) but in the obviative it shifts to a less central third person (‘his’ or ‘her’).
- The ‘locative’ is a noun form used to indicate a location – e.g., the locative form of ‘field’ would mean ‘in the field’ or ‘on the field’.

Q5.1. On your answer sheet, add the missing forms (a)-(v). If you think the form does not exist, write N/A.

Q5.2. Explain your solution on a separate sheet.